



Workshop on Loss and Damage

Abbreviations

AR6 – Sixth Assessment Report

DBI – Digo Bikas Institute

IPCC – Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change

MoFE – Ministry of Forest and Environment

NDRRMA - National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority

NGO – Non-Governmental Organization

OPML – Oxford Policy Management Limited

Acknowledgement

The Digo Bikas Institute team would like to express our sincere appreciation towards Mr. Anil Pokharel- CEO at National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA), Dr. Bimal Regmi- Sernior Consultant, Police and Institutions Facility, Oxford Policy Management Limited (OPML), Mr. Hari Prasad Sharma – Under Secretary (Technical) Climate Change Management Division, Ministry of Forest and Environment (MoFE), and Mr. Abhishek Shrestha- Program Director, Digo Bikas Institute (DBI), for your time and contribution in helping enhance the success of the “Workshop on Loss and Damage”.

We are also thankful towards Ms. Apsara Lamsal – Vice Chairperson, Helambu Rural Municipality, Mr. Lalan Raut – Ward Chairperson, Ward no. 6, Tilathi Koiladi Rural Municipality, and Mr. Shyam Sundar Mukhiya – Farmer, Hanumannagar Kankalini Municipality for honoring us and all the participants of the workshop with the opportunity to listen to your accounts on the sorrowful experiences and concerns you have personally faced in your municipalities in regards to loss and damage.

We would like to extend our gratitude to all the participants who, with their active participation in the conversations between the major stakeholders of loss and damage, highlighted the importance of addressing the condition of people who have suffered immediate loss and damage.

We would also like to thank Mr. Prayash Adhikari for moderating the workshop in a successful manner.

Lastly, we would like to thank Hotel Himalaya for the logistical support they provided during the event.

Contributors

Abhishek Shrestha

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Executive Summary

Nepal faced severe climate-induced loss and damage in Melamchi and post-monsoon rainfall in Tarai Madhesh in 2021 and 2022, resulting in substantial economic and non-economic losses associated with loss and damage. Local government, community organizations and the people at grassroot level are least aware of climate-induced loss and damage. It is imperative to document, communicate and share these stories of loss and damage within National and International communities to highlight the challenges we are currently facing.

With this objective, Digo Bikas Institute (DBI) organized a Workshop on Loss and Damage. The primary aim of this workshop was to bring together various stakeholders, including decision-makers involved in climate policy, government representatives, NGOs, researchers, academia, and community representatives who are directly affected by loss and damage impacts.

The main objectives of this workshop were:

1. To bring forward the experiences and concerns on climate induced loss and damage of the local people in the light of policy makers.
2. To facilitate a discourse between various stakeholders who are directly affected by loss and damage impacts and find a way forward to dealing with the issues by identify gaps and challenges in addressing loss and damage and discuss potential solutions.
3. To foster collaboration and knowledge exchange among stakeholders working in the field of climate change adaptation and resilience.
4. To develop an understanding of loss and damage in Nepal's Context, AR6 and Loss and Damage, an update on loss and damage negotiations, and strengthen collaboration and knowledge sharing on loss and damage issues.

Local representatives, government officials, and climate professionals in the sector were among the panelists. The conversations focused on the personal experiences of local representatives and farmers, who discussed the severe socioeconomic consequences of loss and damage. Experts highlighted the difficulties in defining and measuring loss and damage in light of scientific studies from the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC).

Government delegates underlined the central government's efforts to solve these concerns, as well as the importance of fair and accountable data from the ground. Participants expressed worries about quantifying non-economic losses and the significance of undertaking additional research to demand compensation from the international community. The workshop also underlined the importance of following up on the negotiating process and representing Nepal's communities with tangible and mutually acceptable demands.

Moving forward, it was agreed that ongoing conversations and interactions with local stakeholders are critical. Coordination and collaboration among many stakeholders are required to uncover real problems and encourage successful solutions. Adequate finance should be deployed through international entities to address loss and damage at local level.

The Workshop on Loss and Damage provided a forum for local representatives and community members to express their experiences and long-term consequences of losses and damages to which they had not previously contributed. The program established a bridge between community voices and stakeholder activities, highlighting the significance of research, collaboration, and strong negotiation to address the community's concerns. The participants also requested the Government of Nepal to engage in the loss and damage transitional community meeting and make loss and damage as the key priority agenda for Nepal in the upcoming COP 28 in UAE.

Furthermore, during the discussion, the participants urged the Government of Nepal to submit strong case study of loss and damage to the Loss and Damage Transitional Committee meetings and workshops.



Background

In 2021 and 2022, heavy post-monsoon rainfall struck Nepal resulting in severe climate-induced loss and damage, substantial economic and non-economic losses, in Melamchi and Terai Madhesh.

The floodwaters from the Melamchi river in July 2021 flooded villages and the major market, displacing over 100 households and caused significant damage. This resulted in the deaths of twenty people. The floods wrecked resorts, bridges, and buildings, as well as trout farms. However, the floods cannot be blamed purely on rainfall because the data does not show an unusually high amount of rain in the area. Landslides, damaged soil from earthquakes, and makeshift dams obstructing the river's flow could all have played a role in the disaster.

Similarly, in October 2021, untimely rainfall began to pour in the western portion of Nepal, causing significant loss of ready-to-harvest paddy in the field. The rain was the cause of economic and non-economic loss in Nepal, making it difficult for the Nepalese people to support themselves throughout the year.

Saptari was the district in province 2 with the most damage to paddy crops. According to the ministry, 66,150 hectares of paddy were planted in Saptari, and 16,537 hectares of paddy were damaged. Similarly, 58,000 hectares of paddy were planted in Siraha, and 8,700 hectares of paddy were damaged. Out of 58,000 hectares of paddy cultivation in Dhanusha, 4,680 hectares were damaged, in Mahottari, 3,078 hectares were damaged while cultivated in 45,500 hectares, and 7,400 hectares were damaged in Sarlahi, out of 43,000 hectares.

In terms of percentage, 25 percent of paddy was damaged in Saptari, 15 in Siraha, 8 in Dhanusha, 7 in Mahottari, 16 in Sarlahi, 8 in Rautahat, 9 in Bara, and 2 percent in Parsa.

To emphasize the issues Nepal has been currently facing, it is critical to document, discuss, and share these stories of loss and damage throughout national and international communities. DBI organized a workshop on loss and damage the primary goal of the workshop being to bring together many stakeholders, including climate policy decision-makers, government representatives, NGOs, researchers, academia, and community representatives who are directly affected by loss and damage repercussions. The workshop also aimed to improve awareness of loss and damage in Nepal's context, AR6 and Loss and Damage, provide an update on loss and damage negotiations, and strengthen collaboration and knowledge exchange on loss and damage challenges.

Local representatives, Ms. Apsara Lamsal (Vice Chairperson, Helambu Rural Municipality), Mr. Lalan Raut (Tilathi-Koiladi Rural Municipality), and Mr. Shyam Sundar Mukhiya (Farmer, Hanuman Nagar Kankalini Municipality), Mr. Anil Pokharel (CEO of NDRRMA), Dr. Bimal Regmi (OPML), Mr. Hari Sharma (Climate Change Management Division, MoFE), and Mr. Abhishek Shrestha (DBI) were the panelists and the workshop brought together a diverse group of participants including Government and Non-Government representatives, Farmers, Social activist, Advocates, Young researchers, Young activist, and different stakeholders working within the issues of climate-induced Loss and Damage.



Massive destruction from Melamchi Flood in 2021



Local representatives and local farmer from Helambu and Saptari



Massive destruction of paddy due to untimely rainfall in 2021

Key Discussion

The local representatives and farmers voiced their concerns regarding their pain and sorrowful experience as an impact of Loss and Damage. The incident not only had an acute effect on the community but still has socio-economic impacts that the community is going through.

The experts tried to connect the ground voices with the scientific facts and research done by IPCC and how the national and international community has been dealing with these issues. The Loss and Damage have not yet had a clear definition that could encompass every intersectional section. Research is very much required in this field to quantify our losses and strongly demand reparation within the international community so governmental and non-governmental institutions should also focus on research.

Additionally, Governmental representatives focused on several attempts that the central government has been making within these issues and the challenges that we are facing currently to have fair and accountable data from the ground. Quantification of non-economic losses is also a matter of concern that we need to discuss. The need to follow up the negotiation process with concrete and common demands representing Nepal and our communities was also brought to the discussion by the Panelist. The upcoming meetings of Transitional Committee and possibilities to follow up and have a meaningful engagement were also discussed.

The research publication of DBI on “Climate Induced Loss and Damage, Economic Losses: A Case Study of Hanumannagar Kankalini Municipality, Saptari District, Nepal” was shared in the workshop. The findings of the research showed that 7250 Tons of Rice has been lost due to the floodwaters which resulted in heavy loss of the ready-to-harvest rice that was not collected and worth of NPR 18 crore 10 lakh 11 thousand and one hundred only, i.e., 1.4 million USD in Hanumannagar Kankalini Municipality, Saptari.



Participants of the Workshop on Loss and Damage

The participation was astounding with various concerns, suggestions, and questions placed, the need for research, the capacity of local government, Climate finance, critical analysis of governmental steps to prioritize climate loans, capacity building of the community to strengthen their resiliency to losses and damages were major issues discussed by the participants.

The participants also requested the Government of Nepal to engage in the Loss and Damage Transitional Committee meeting and make loss and damage as the key priority agenda for Nepal in the upcoming COP 28 in UAE. Furthermore, during the discussion, the participants urged the Government of Nepal to submit strong case study of loss and damage to the Loss and Damage Transitional Committee meetings and workshops.



*Presentation by Dr. Bimal Regmi- Sernior Consultant,
Police and Institutions Facility, Oxford Policy
Management Limited (OPML)*



*Presentation by Mr. Abhishek Shrestha- Program
Director, Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)*



Way Forward

Discussion on the topic of concern participation of the local level stakeholders like this is very much needed and need to be followed up by several other meetings and discussion as well. There is a need for coordination and collaboration among multi-stakeholders with identifying real problems and promoting real solutions so that we could strengthen the capacity of the local community to become resilient to unavoidable losses and damage that the community has been facing because of historical emissions. Conservation and promotion of local resources for sustainability and advocacy among national and international communities are very much needed in this issue.



Presentation by Mr. Anil Pokharel- CEO at National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA)



Presentation by Mr. Hari Prasad Sharma- Under Secretary (Technical) Climate Change Management Division, Ministry of Forest and Environment (MoFE)

Conclusion

Workshop on Loss and Damage was a platform for local representatives and local community people to voice their painful experiences and long-term effects that they have been going through because of several losses and damages to which they have not been a historical contributor. Different stakeholders were able to make a connection with those voices from the community and share their learnings, efforts, and activities that they have been doing in the field of Loss and Damage with keeping the community in the front face.

In this regard, the negotiators in negotiating to establish new funding arrangements for assisting developing countries in response to loss and damage, in order to operationalize these new funding arrangements and the fund, established a Transitional Committee and tasked it with preparing recommendations to be adopted by COP 28 and CMA 5. Governmental stakeholders are also doing their part but this is not enough to address what our community is going through so there is a need of strong research, collaboration, and strong negotiation to promote a real solution to the problems.

The National Framework on Climate Induced Loss and Damage of Nepal states that 65% of all disaster-related annual death is caused by climate-induced disaster. This clearly shows that Nepal is prone to climate-induced disasters, and the people in Nepal are only going to be more vulnerable to such disasters, increasing the impact this is going to leave. Thus, the Government of Nepal must do everything in its capacity to increase funding for Nepal in loss and damage funding arrangements. Government of Nepal should also submit strong case studies of loss and damage to international forums and prioritize loss and damage in COP 28. Capacity-building projects should also be directed towards larger grassroot community-based organizations to capacitate on loss and damage challenges.



ANNEX – I Program Schedule

TIME	AGENDA	REMARKS
8:00-9:00	Breakfast and Program Overview	Prayash Adhikari, Digo Bikas Institute
SESSION: 1 LOSS AND DAMAGE IN EXPERIENCE AND INTERNATIONAL STATE [09:00-11:30]		
9:00-9:45	Documentary Screening “Lived reality of loss and damage” and “Monsoon Mayhem” sharing from the loss and damage- impacted community of Hanumananagar Kankalini Municipality and Helambu Municipality	Apsara Lamsal (Vice Chairperson, Helambu Rural Municipality) Lalan Mandal (Ward Chairperson, Ward no. 06, Tilathi Koiladi Rural Municipality) Shyam Sundar Mukhiya (Farmer, Hanuman Nagar)
9:45-10:15	Reflections on the IPCC AR6 Synthesis Report: Loss and damage	Dr. Bimal Regmi, OPML
10:15-10:45	Loss and Damage in Climate Negotiations	Abhishek Shrestha, Digo Bikas Institute
10:45-11:15	Questions and Answers	
11:15-11:30	TEA BREAK	
SESSION: 2 LOSS AND DAMAGE AND NEPAL CONTEXT [11:30-13:00]		
11:30-12:00	Nepal’s response and engagement on loss and Damage.	Anil Pokharel, CEO, National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority
12:00-12:30	Question and Answer Session	
12:30-13:00	Way forward on loss and damage for Nepal	Hari Sharma, Under Secretary (Technical) Climate Change Management Division, Ministry of Forest and Environment
13:00 Onwards	LUNCH	



ANNEX – I I List of Participants

S.N.	Name of Participant	Organization
1.	Abhishek Shrestha	Digo Bikas Institute (DBI)
2.	Bimal R. Regmi	Oxford Policy Management Limited (OPML)
3.	Hari Prasad Sharma	Ministry of Forestry and Environment (MoFE)
4.	Anil Pokharel	National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA)
5.	Rajesh Kumar Jha	Tilathi Koiladi Rural Municipality, Saptari
6.	Amit Pathak	Hanumannagar Kankalini Municipality
7.	Ashok Kumar Shah	Sabal Nepal
8.	Sangita Lama	NEFIN, Climate Change
9.	Deepshikha Nepal	NYCA
10.	Padam Bahadur Shrestha	Environment Law Society Nepal
11.	Binod Parajuli	CRR Lab
12.	Dinesh Gurung	DCA
13.	Sabin Adhikari	People in Need (PIN)
14.	Goma Karki	Youth Innovation Lab
15.	Sugat Bhattarai	RRN/APMDD
16.	Prakriti Koirala	TU
17.	Pratap Maharjan	Action Aid
18.	Aruna Koju	Action Aid
19.	Lisa Garu	Action Aid
20.	Yogendra Subedi	ISSET Nepal
21.	Bidur Subedi	Human Rights Alliance
22.	Indira Shreesh	INWOLAG
23.	Keshar Auji	DANAR
24.	Prabin Man Singh	PRC
25.	Rita Bastakoti	NFGF Nepal
26.	Shree Ram Subedi	Nagarik
27.	Shikchhya Yonzon	FIAN
28.	Jamuna Tamang	NIDWAN
29.	Jimmy Lama	HELP
30.	Shatkon Shrestha	Environment Law Society Nepal
31.	Prakash Shrestha	HELP
32.	Shreya K.C.	YOUNGO
33.	Omkar Subedi	DBI
34.	Apeksha Chalise	DBI
35.	Prayash Adhikari	DBI

